finds himself hindered in battle once he recognizes the Winter Soldier—unable to give his all while fighting his best friend.

"Bucky was a wonderful guy—his best friend—and Steve thought he died and felt some guilt for his death," says Stephen McFeely, co-writer of the film along with Christopher Markus. "Then he finds out Bucky is actually alive, trying to kill him and working for the bad guys. There is no worse thing that could happen to Steve Rogers, particularly in a movie that's about trust."

His former sidekick is highly skilled and powerful, and Steve Rogers is handicapped by sentimentality—and by the gut instinct that Bucky cannot possibly be in control of his faculties.

"Captain America is still a man out of time in the movie, but the other important aspect of this film is friendship," Creative Executive Trinh Tran says. "He thought he lost his friend in WWII, and now he realizes at this movie's midway point that his friend is back and working on the other side."

Steve Rogers develops new friendships during the course of the film. Black Widow has fled with him, helping him hide in the shadows, and Sam Wilson is introduced as Captain America's best friend and partner in the modern era. Steve and Natasha initially go to Sam for shelter because he is outside the S.H.I.E.L.D. system and can be trusted.

Ryan Meinerding, Head of Visual Development, talks about the conflict between Falcon's original 1969 comic-book persona and his appearance on-screen: "You don't get to a place of modernization with Falcon. I feel like his fans love the red-and-white costume and the pet falcon, which he doesn't have here."

On-screen, Wilson trades his spandex and red feathers for the Exo-7 Falcon apparatus and doesn't have a mental connection



Clockwise from Left: Nick Fury (Bryan Hitch), Black Widow (Tomm Coker & Daniel Freedman), Maria Hill and Sharon Carter (Mike Perkins & Frank D'Armata)